

Scoring — Faan

Most tables have a **3-faan** minimum to win, with an upper limit of **13 faan**. Faan do not stack with their constituents. Use this guide as a learning aid, not a referee. House rules vary.

Bonus & Situational

Self-Draw – draw the winning tile from the wall	1
Concealed – no claimed discards except the winning tile	1
Win on Last Tile – win on the last tile of the wall	1
Win by Kong – win on a replacement tile after a kong	1
Robbing the Kong – win on a tile used to form a kong	1
Win by Double Kong – win on a tile from a kong, which itself was from a kong	8
Heavenly Hand – dealer wins on the initial 14-tile dealt hand	Limit
Earthly Hand – win on dealer's first discard	Limit

Winning Hand Patterns

Chicken Hand **0 faan**
Mixed suits, sequences, and triplets.



All Triplets **3 faan**
Four triplets/quads plus a pair.



Mixed Terminals **4 faan**
1s, 9s, and honors only.



Small Three Dragons **5 faan**
Two dragon triplets/quads and a dragon pair.



Full Flush **7 faan**
All one suit, no honors.



All Honors **10 faan**
Only wind and dragon tiles.



Big Four Winds **Limit**
A triplet/quad of each wind, plus a pair.



Nine Gates **Limit**
Pure suit 1112345678999 plus one extra.



Flowers & Seasons

No Flowers – no flower or season tiles	1
Seat Flower – flower matching your seat	1
Seat Season – season matching your seat	1
Four Flowers – stacks with seat flower	2
Four Seasons – stacks with seat season	2
Seven Robbing One – seven flowers and seasons; can rob the remaining tile from another player when drawn; auto-win	5
Eight Immortals Crossing Sea – eight flowers and seasons; auto-win	Limit

Honors

Dragons – dragon triplet or quad	1 each
Seat Wind – wind triplet or quad	1
Round Wind – wind triplet or quad	1

All Sequences **1 faan**
Four sequences and a pair.



Half Flush **3 faan**
One suit plus honors.



Seven Pairs **4 faan**
Seven unique pairs.



Small Four Winds **6 faan**
Three wind triplets/quads and a wind pair.



Big Three Dragons **8 faan**
A triplet/quad of each dragon.



All Terminals **10 faan**
Only 1s and 9s.



Thirteen Orphans **Limit**
One of each terminal and honor, plus one duplicate.



Four Quads **Limit**
Four kongs plus a pair.



Lucky Cat Mahjong

Hong Kong Mahjong Guide

About Us

Lucky Cat Mahjong was founded by Jorge Yau and Sophia Huang in November 2025 with a simple goal: to make mahjong accessible and build a thriving third-space community around it. Every month, we organize two free community events: a large social gathering open to the public, and a mahjong invitational tournament at a special location to recognize and celebrate our most active and deserving members.

We specialize in organizing Hong Kong mahjong events and teaching fundamentals, points, and strategy. Whether you're picking up tiles for the first time or looking to level up, our sessions will give you the skills and confidence to sit down at any table.

How to Get Involved

Support Our Cause

Our mission is to make mahjong accessible to everyone and use it as a powerful tool for connection and connecting with Asian culture. Our core values are **RICE**—Respect, Integrity, Community, and Empathy. Support us by telling your friends, inviting them to our events, teaching newcomers, and bringing mahjong sets to our free community events.

Volunteer

Volunteer at our events! We always need people to help greet attendees, teach newcomers, bring mahjong sets, and carry out event logistics. As a thank you, our volunteers get free entry to paid events, and our most dedicated and consistent volunteers will be recognized on our website and get the opportunity to attend exclusive events.



SCAN TO VISIT

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Setting Up & Basic Play

The Objective

Be the first to complete **four melds and one pair** (14 tiles), drawing from the wall or claiming discards. The minimum hand value to win is 3 faan.

The Tiles

Characters

Circles

Bamboos

Honors

Flowers & Seasons

1. Build the Walls

Shuffle all 144 tiles face down. Each player builds a wall **18 stacks long and 2 tiles high** (36 tiles each), then pushes the walls together into a square.

2. Roll the Dice for the Break

The dealer (East) rolls three dice and sums the total. Go counter-clockwise around the table starting with East as 1 to determine which player's wall to break. Then count the same dice total from the beginning of their wall moving clockwise to make the break.

Seat	Dice totals			
East	5	9	13	17
South	6	10	14	18
West	3	7	11	15
North	4	8	12	16

3. Deal the Tiles

Deal in groups of four tiles going counter-clockwise, while drawing clockwise until everyone has **13 tiles**. Everyone draws replacement tiles for any bonus tiles, starting with the dealer. The dealer draws one extra to make **14** and starts by discarding a tile.

4. The Flow of Play

Take turns playing counter-clockwise (East → South → West → North). Draw clockwise from the wall. Between turns you may claim a discarded tile instead of drawing to complete a meld by revealing it. End your turn by discarding a tile.

Core Concepts

What Is a Meld?

A **meld** is a legal set of tiles that counts toward your winning hand. In Hong Kong mahjong you need **four melds plus one pair**. Melds can stay hidden in your hand (concealed) or be laid face-up after you claim a discard (exposed).

The Melds

Chi Sequence
Three tiles in a consecutive run of one suit (e.g. 2-3-4 Characters). Only claimable from the player on your left.

Pung Triplet
Three identical tiles. You may claim a matching discard from any player. Has priority over a chi.

Kong Quad
Four identical tiles. Claim a discard to make an exposed kong, or declare a concealed kong when you draw the fourth yourself. After either, draw a replacement tile from the end of the wall.

Pair The Eyes
Two identical tiles that complete the hand. Every winning hand needs exactly one pair.

Winning on the Last Tile

You can win by **self-drawing** the last tile you need from the wall, or by **claiming** that tile from anyone's discard. A win has the highest priority over chi, pung, and kong. If more than one player needs the same discard tile to win, the next player in the turn order wins.

Concealed vs. Exposed

A hand is **concealed** if you never claim a discard tile (except the winning tile). Concealed hands and self-draws earn bonus faan. Claiming discards **exposes** those melds face-up on the table for everyone to see.

Flowers & Seasons

Eight bonus tiles. They never form melds. Set them aside when drawn and take a replacement tile from the end of the wall. They can add bonus faan at the end.

Plum

Orchid

Chrysanthemum

Bamboo

Spring

Summer

Autumn

Winter